



Homer Community Consolidated School District 33C

Board of Education

Board Meeting Summary - April 22, 2025

*Christopher Trzeciak, President - Melissa Chandarana, Vice President - Aaron Wolf, Secretary
Elizabeth Hitzeman, Member - Deb Martin, Member, - Josh Oster, Member - Lilly Miceli, Member*

Recognition of Visitors/Communication to the Board

7th Grade Girls Volleyball State Qualifiers

- Fratto, Amelia
- Balderrama, Olivia
- Baranauskas, Eva
- McGraw, Taylor
- Menconi, Kate
- Prawdzik, Marie
- Pfeiffer, Kali
- Duer, Adyson
- O'Keefe, Maeve
- Menconi, Kennedy
- Keblusek, Sophia
- Ashton, Callie
- Leahy, Norah
- Diorio, Kara
- Bafia, Emily
- Enders, Aubrey
- Coach Kirsten Selof

8th Grade Girls Volleyball State Qualifiers

- Isla Bruce
- Brooklyn Chesna
- Charlotte Gagliardi
- Sydney Grijalva
- Chloe Kouba
- Olivia Lavaty
- Megan Marusarz
- Mercy Owotuyi
- Annaka Wettergen
- Lauren Czajkowski
- Paige Naughton
- Brooklyn Santo
- Gabriela Potempa
- Audrina Chavez

- Coach Jeff Weathers

Wrestling IESA State Qualifiers

- Barrett Kocsis
- Wyatt McClain
- Zain Askar
- Hank Hough
- Alex Hubbart
- Troy Healy
- Johnny Paun
- Logan Lechtenberg
- Jack Gliwa
- Griffin Elder
- Connor McKinney
- Caiden Wallow
- Joseph Ponterio
- Lucas VanderMeer
- Aiden Anzar
- Deymeatrius Moseley
- David Rush - Coach

Recognition of Visitors/Communication to the Board

Mr. Halberstadt shared concerns about the transition from the Discovery Program to Advanced Learner Placement

President Announces the Newly Elected Members of the Board of Education

- Mr. Aaron Wolf
- Mrs. Melissa Chandarana
- Mr. Josh Oster
- Mrs. Lilly Miceli

Election of Officers

- President: Mr. Chris Trzeciak
- Vice President: Mrs. Melissa Chandarana
- Secretary: Mr. Aaron Wolf

Consent Agenda

- Approval of the March 18, 2025 Regular Board meeting minutes. (Goal 4)
- Treasurer's Report March 2025 (Goal 5)
- Invoices Payable April 2025 (Goal 5)

Personnel Recommendations

1) Resignations

Certified

- 1) Jason Skube - Assistant Principal at Hadley Middle School - eff. 6/30/25
- 2) Rebecca Bauer - Special Education Teacher at Young School - eff 6/5/25

Non-Certified

- 1) Jacob DeNardo - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 6/30/25

Extra-Curricular

- 1) Jennifer Jeffries - Homer Jr. High Honors Club - eff. immediately
- 2) Kristen Hottinger - Mustang Buddies Sponsor at Goodings Grove School - eff 3/18/25
- 3) Annette Jung - Mustang Buddies Sponsor at Goodings Grove School - eff 6/5/25
- 4) Shannon Schroeder - Natural Helpers Co-Sponsor - eff. 6/6/25

Separation of Employment

- 1) Ted Cachampis - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 4/23/25

2) Request(s) for Leave of Absence (beginning and end dates open to modification)

Certified

Non-Certified

- 1) Alesa Geraghty - School Psychologist at Young School - FMLA extension - intermittently through the end of the 2025-2026 school year.
- 2) Jean Riha - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 4/2/25 - 5/2/25, returning on 5/5/25
- 3) Bridie Hearne - Bus Driver at Transportation - FMLA extension from 3/31/25 - 4/14/25
- 4) Joan Kryl - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 3/27/25 through the end of the 2024-2025 school year
- 5) Tina Ivers - Paraprofessional at Homer Jr. High School - eff. 2/24/25 - 3/11/25, returning on 3/12/25 and a second medical leave from 4/21/25 - 5/12/25, returning on 5/13/25

3) Employment Recommendation(s)

Certified

- 1) Kiera Mackin - Speech/Language Pathologist at Goodings Grove School - eff. 8/21/25
- 2) Therese Byers - Special Education Teacher at Young School - eff. 8/21/25
- 3) Olivia Kuncis - Kindergarten Teacher at Goodings Grove School - eff. 8/21/25
- 4) Colleen Hassell - Special Education Teacher at Homer Jr. High School - eff.

8/21/25

Non-Certified

- 1) Kenneth Martens - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 4/23/25, dependent on successfully completing his criminal background check and the FMCSA background check as he already has his CDL for driving a school bus.
- 2) Jeffrey Stewart - Bus Driver at Transportation - eff. 5/23/25, dependent on successfully completing his criminal background check, the FMCSA background check and obtaining his CDL for driving a school bus.

Extra-Curricular

- 1) Joyce Hale - Girls Cross Country Coach - eff. Immediately

Informational Reports

Homer Council Report

Ms. Bruin and Ms. Piper welcomed the new Board of Education members. Ms. Bruin shared that teachers wear “red for ed” in support of teachers. Ms. Bruin also shared that she appreciates the open communication with district administrators and can answer any questions the Board members may have.

Homer Support Staff Council Report

Ms. Sechek reported that their union wears blue, and an email went out to everyone about the upcoming Red Cross Blood Drive on May 15th in the boardroom at the administration building from 11:00-5:00 pm. She also welcomed the new Board members and congratulated Board members on their new appointments.

Principal Report

Goodings Grove: Mr. Eric Kraatz

Mr. Kraatz’s report is attached.

Directors' Reports

Buildings and Grounds

Mr. Russ’ presentation is attached.

Special Services

Mrs. Karalus’ presentation is attached.

Assistant Superintendent Reports

Curriculum

Ms. Figurell's presentation is attached.

Human Resources

Dr. Portwood's presentation is attached.

Superintendent's Report

Dr. Schoppe's report is attached.

Approved Old Business

Approved New Business

- Approved wage adjustment for lunch/recess monitors
- Hired a 1.0 FTE SI Teacher position at Hadley Middle School for the 2025-2026 school year
- Approved an additional .2 FTE Speech and Language Pathologist, which creates a full 1.0 FTE position for the 2025-2026 school year.
- Approved an additional 1.0 FTE Social Worker for the 2025-2026 school year
- Renewed the Intergovernmental Agreement with New Lenox School District 122 for Orientation and Mobility Services for the 2025-2026 school year
- Approved the MOU between Homer CCSD 33C and the Homer District 33-C Council of the American Federation of Teachers Local 604 to modify Article IV.D.2 of the parties 2024-2027 collective bargaining agreement
- April 2025 Policy 4:60 Purchasing Approvals
 - Nevco - Scoreboard and installation for the softball field at Homer Jr. High/Hadley: estimated at \$30,214.
 - Apple Inc and other vendors - Cost for 60 iPads and accessories to facilitate KDG MAP Testing for the 2025-2026 school year: estimated at \$31,300.
 - Ekkert Environmental Services (EES) - Periodically required Radon testing at all buildings: estimated at \$13,356
 - ECS Midwest, LLC - Soil boring and geotechnical testing at Goodings Grove: estimated at \$18,100
 - Building Automation Solutions - HVAC VAV (Variable Air Volume) Repairs at Schilling: estimated at \$17,800
 - Tria Architecture - Project authorization for architecture and engineering work to install a building generator at Goodings Grove School: estimated at \$34,750.

- Approved the job description for instructional coach
- Approved 2.0 FTE instructional coaches for the 2025-2026 school year
- Appointed Holly Odom as the Assistant Principal at Hadley Middle School and approve the contract with an annual salary of \$90,000, effective 7/1/25
- Awarded the contract for 2025 Interior Painting at Homer Junior High and Hadley Middle Schools - project # 25-008 - to Chicago Heights Construction Company in the amount of \$519,915.00
- We are seeking a motion and a second to approve (5.5%) wage increases for all non-bargaining Support Staff positions listed below
 - Administrative Assistant to the Superintendent
 - Administrative Assistant for Business
 - Afterschool Enrichment Coordinator
 - Benefits Coordinator
 - Multimedia Specialist
 - Network Specialist
 - Occupational Therapist
 - Physical Therapist
 - Board Certified Behavior Analyst
 - Technology employees (10 month)
 - Transportation Dispatcher
- Approved one Summer Technology Installer for 2025
- Awarded the contract for 2025 Seal Coating and Maintenance - district project #2025-2 - to Denler, Inc. in the amount of \$93,470.93

The next Board meeting will be held on Tuesday, May 27, at 7:00 p.m.